

Windows 11

Everything New and Improved?
Or is it just old win in a new bottle?

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The new Windows 11 comes with a 'frosted glass' look that people are either going to hate or love. Is it as big a transition as XP to Vista? Perhaps. But people are more used to a glassy effect on things now, so maybe it won't be as hated as Vista was. Love it or hate it, it's here to stay and Microsoft has incorporated this 'frosted glass' look system wide. Some more subtle improvements to design include system wide rounded corners. We're not going to just rattle off the changes in the intro paragraph itself, so perhaps it's best to look at what's new in Windows 11 in a more structured manner. We'll break the new stuff into changes in design and changes in software, and try and cover as much as we can.

DESIGN CHANGES

Taskbar

The taskbar in Windows 11 has gone through a major design upgrade. All the icons and the start button have

been centered by default instead of the familiar left aligned start button. And of course everything is 'frosted glass'.

Don't worry though, if this Mac-like center-aligned feel is not for you. You can choose to move it all back to the left to feel more at home. In Windows 10, all open applications have a line/band under them. With Windows 11 these are replaced by smaller dots or dashes.

One somewhat negative change is that you will no longer be able to dock this taskbar to the top, left or right of the screen. It's locked to the bottom of the screen now. Of course this is based on the leaked Windows 11 build that's not final yet, so perhaps the final build might allow it.

Start Menu

Don't worry, Microsoft hasn't pulled a Windows 8 on us and has done away with the Start Menu completely. Instead, along with the taskbar, they have centered the Start Menu too. The Start Menu itself has been changed completely, and no longer features

a long scrolling list of all the apps installed on your device. Instead, the Menu will feature your most used/pinned apps at the top in a grid and a 'Recommended' section for the recently accessed files or recently installed apps.

If you have noticed, there is a new search icon too. As of now, we aren't exactly sure why it is there because you can search from the Start Menu directly either by just directly typing or clicking the search bar and then typing. Clicking on the search icon seems to bring up the Start Menu again, but with the search bar in focus.

Widgets

Microsoft discontinued the Windows 7 Gadgets project citing vulnerabilities in security. They're back now in the form of Widgets in Windows 11. This is because Microsoft is integrating apps more into Windows than ever before. The Live Tiles attempt in Windows 10 didn't really work, but we're actually pretty hopeful that the new widgets will.



The translucent and centered taskbar of Windows 11



Notice the 'dots' that indicate the open Apps